# PROSPER AWUNI

**Senior Threat Detection Analyst | Security Operations Centre (SOC) Escalation, Threat Hunting and Detection Engineering**

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## PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Threat Detection Analyst with over five years of experience operating as the senior technical escalation point for Security Operations Centre (SOC) functions, coordinating SOC response activities, performing threat hunting, and driving continuous improvement of detection and triage processes. I bring deep expertise in SIEM platforms including CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, alongside hands-on experience with Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), identity threat detection, and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) automation. I am skilled in analysing and improving analyst workflows, translating detection hypotheses into operational use cases mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, and communicating complex security findings to both technical and non-technical audiences.

## CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SOC Escalation and Coordination:** Senior escalation point for complex incidents, analyst mentoring, Security Operations Centre (SOC) process improvement, triage quality management
- **Threat Detection and Hunting:** Detection rule engineering, proactive threat hunting, MITRE ATT&CK framework coverage mapping, behavioural analytics
- **SIEM Platforms:** CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel (Kusto Query Language (KQL)), Splunk (Search Processing Language (SPL))
- **EDR and XDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, Falcon Prevent, Falcon Insight, Falcon Discover, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender XDR
- **SOAR Automation:** Playbook engineering, automated triage, alert enrichment, incident workflow automation
- **Incident Response:** NIST SP 800-61 lifecycle, containment, eradication, recovery, post-incident review
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Scripting:** PowerShell automation, detection-as-code development
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), Center for Internet Security (CIS) Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**University of the Arts, London (UAL)**
**Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer** *March 2025 – Present*

- Act as the senior SOC escalation point for all complex security incidents, performing in-depth investigation across endpoint, identity, email, and cloud telemetry to determine root cause, scope, and business impact.
- Coordinate SOC response activities across concurrent incidents, managing prioritisation, analyst tasking, and stakeholder communication in line with incident severity and organisational risk appetite.
- Engineer and tune detection rules across CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel using KQL, improving triage processes and reducing false-positive volumes to increase analyst efficiency.
- Perform proactive threat hunting operations using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel, mapping adversarial behaviours to MITRE ATT&CK and introducing new detection hypotheses derived from threat intelligence.
- Develop SOAR automation playbooks to streamline alert triage, enrichment, and initial containment steps, improving consistency and speed of initial SOC response.
- Lead post-incident reviews and lessons-learned sessions, translating findings into concrete detection improvements, runbook updates, and analyst training recommendations.

- Oversee Vulnerability Management using Tenable.io, Nessus, and Pentera BAS, integrating findings into the threat detection programme to ensure coverage of actively exploited vulnerabilities.

**University of the Arts, London (UAL)**
**Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity** *March 2022 – March 2025*

- Performed comprehensive alert triage and investigation across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon, coordinating SOC responses and improving triage processes to reduce mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR).
- Developed custom KQL detection queries in Microsoft Sentinel and SPL searches in Splunk, improving signal quality and contributing to the SOC's detection use-case library.
- Conducted threat hunting operations using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight to identify credential harvesting, lateral movement, and persistence mechanisms mapped to MITRE ATT&CK.
- Supported deployment and configuration of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across the university estate, contributing to tuning of detection policies and alert thresholds.
- Authored incident response runbooks, threat hunting guides, and analyst operational documentation, raising SOC maturity and standardising response procedures.
- Administered Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) and Conditional Access policies, hardening identity security controls and reducing the attack surface for identity-based threats.

**HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS / FinTech)**
**IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure** *February 2021 – March 2022*

- Supported security monitoring and alert management within a Software as a Service (SaaS) FinTech environment, contributing to incident triage, security tooling administration, and infrastructure hardening.
- Assisted with endpoint protection deployment, access control administration, and security audit activities, gaining broad foundational experience in enterprise security operations.

## KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built and operationalised a threat-hunting capability aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, proactively identifying credential abuse, lateral movement, and persistence activities and translating findings into new SIEM detection use cases.
- Engineered SOAR automation playbooks that improved triage consistency and reduced analyst manual effort on common incident types, freeing capacity for deeper investigation work.
- Designed and deployed custom Microsoft Sentinel KQL detection rules, significantly improving alert fidelity and reducing false-positive rates within the SOC.
- Directed deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across approximately 8,000 users, delivering comprehensive EDR coverage and improving SOC visibility across the full endpoint estate.
- Led UAL's successful Cyber Essentials Plus certification, coordinating technical evidence gathering and cross-team remediation across all five control categories.

## EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

## CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate